



Market Research & Go-to-Market Playbook

Statute-cited corporate records for the missing middle — solo attorneys, small law firms, CPA practices, registered agents, and DIY founders.

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1. Executive Summary

entityIQ is a web-based corporate records system covering LLCs, Corporations, S-Corps, LLC-S, Single-Member LLCs, and Non-Profits. It produces statute-cited, audit-defensible minute books, stock ledgers, AI-drafted bylaws and operating agreements, share-transaction history, banking authority records, leases, loans, Form 1023-EZ screening, and one-click PDF record books — designed for the way solo attorneys and small firms actually work.

The thesis

The US entity-management market is bifurcated. CSC, Diligent, and Athennian charge \$25K–\$250K+/yr for enterprise-grade governance. ZenBusiness, LegalZoom, and Northwest treat post-formation records as an upsell. Carta and Pulley serve VC-backed C-Corps only. No well-funded US product is purpose-built for the solo attorney or 1–10 person firm managing 20–200 closely-held entities. That is entityIQ's wedge — and the basis for a \$12–24M ARR business in three years.

Five plays — ranked

Play	Name	Effort	Impact	Payback
A	Wisconsin Attorney Beachhead	Medium	High	3–4 mo
B	CPA Channel Partnership	Medium	High	4–6 mo
C	Registered-Agent White-Label	High	High	9–12 mo
D	SEO + Template-Led Growth	Low	Medium	6–9 mo
E	DIY SMB via Incorporator Partnerships	Medium	Medium	12+ mo

2. Product Positioning

entityIQ is the statute-cited, audit-defensible corporate records system that turns a chaotic shoebox of LLC, Corp, and Non-Profit paperwork into a clean, AI-assisted minute book — in one click.

Statutorily grounded. Every meeting, resolution, and ledger entry maps to a specific section of Wis. Stat. Ch. 180/181/183, with a roadmap to all 50 states. No template kit produces this audit trail.

Single source of truth. share_transactions drives every ownership calculation; the system recalculates units, interest %, and capital accounts automatically — eliminating spreadsheet drift across years and partners.

AI-assisted but lawyer-owned. AI drafts bylaws, operating agreements, resolutions, and 1023-EZ screening; the attorney always reviews and signs. Built for professionals, not chatbots.

One-click record book. Compile a court-ready PDF binder (Arial 11pt, 1.25" binder margin, steel-blue headers, AI summary) with cover, TOC, bylaws, minutes, ledger, certificates in seconds.

Multi-entity, multi-tenant, secure. RBAC, encrypted SSN/EIN, signed-URL document delivery, 30-min idle timeout, 12-char password minimum, HIBP detection. Built for firms with 20–500 client entities.

3. Market Sizing

US entity universe

Population	Count	Source
Active US LLCs	~21.0M	IRS SOI + state SOS filings, 2023
Active US C-Corps + S-Corps	~6.0M	IRS SOI Corporation Returns, 2023
US Non-Profits (501(c))	~1.5M	IRS EO Master File, 2024
US active attorneys	1.33M	ABA Profile of the Legal Profession, 2024
Solo + small firms (1–10 attys)	~620K attorneys	ABA, 2024 (~75% of private practice)
CPA firms (1–20 staff)	~32K firms	AICPA + Census NAICS 541211
Active CPAs	~672K	NASBA, 2023
Registered-agent / CSC firms	~3,500	Industry trade estimates

TAM / SAM / SOM

Tier	Value	Math
TAM	\$4.2B / yr	All US entities × \$150 blended annual records spend
SAM	\$680M / yr	~3.4M entities actively maintained by a professional × \$200/yr
SOM (Y3)	\$12–24M ARR	1.5–3% capture of professional segment via WI beachhead + CPA channel + RA OEM

4. Competitive Landscape

Competitor	Buyer	Pricing	Key weakness vs. entityIQ
CSC Entity Management	F1000 GCs	Custom (\$25K–\$250K+)	Out of reach for solo/small; no AI; slow UX
Diligent Entities	Enterprise legal ops	Custom (\$30K+ entry)	High implementation cost; overkill for SMB
Athennian	AmLaw 200, mid-market	Tiered ~\$500–\$2K+/mo	Per-entity pricing punishes small firms; light AI
EntityKeeper	10–500 entity mid-market	\$465/mo (≤100 entities)	No statute citations; no cap table; not law-firm native
MinuteBox	Law firms (mostly Canada)	Firm-tier quote	Canadian statute roots; thin US coverage; no AI
Harbor Compliance	Non-profits, SMB	\$99–\$300+/mo + services	Services-led; weak records / minute book
FileForms	Law firms, PE back offices	Quote-based	Filing-centric; not full minute book
Carta / Pulley / Capbase	VC-backed C-Corps	\$0 – \$14K+/yr	C-Corp only; no LLC; no Non-Profit; no minute book
Clerky / Stripe Atlas	First-time DE C-Corp founders	\$500–\$2K one-time	Formation-first; weak ongoing records
ZenBusiness / Northwest / LegalZoom	DIY SMB	\$0–\$300/yr + add-ons	Records is an upsell, not a product; no statute citation

5. Market Gap — Why entityIQ Wins

The missing middle. Enterprise tools (CSC, Diligent, Athennian) cost \$25K+/yr and are over-engineered. DIY incorporators (ZenBusiness, LegalZoom, Northwest) treat ongoing records as a forgotten upsell. Cap-table tools (Carta, Pulley) ignore LLCs and Non-Profits entirely. The one direct competitor (MinuteBox) is Canadian-rooted with thin US statute coverage and no AI drafting.

The wedge. No incumbent ships a statute-cited, AI-drafted, one-click record book at a price point viable for the solo attorney maintaining 20–100 client entities. entityIQ's combination — Wisconsin statute citation engine, share-transaction-as-source-of-truth ledger, AI bylaws/OA generation, encrypted multi-tenant architecture, and a 1-click PDF binder — is currently unique in the US market.

The moat. The statute-citation engine compounds: every state added (IL, MN, IA, MI in Q2; then full 50) widens the gap. The CPA channel adds a second moat — once a CPA firm has 30 clients on the platform, switching cost is real. The white-label RA tier adds a distribution moat by aligning incentives with the channels that compete with ZenBusiness/Northwest.

6. Ideal Customer Profiles & Personas

Sarah — Solo Corporate Attorney

Segment: Solo / 1–5 attorney firms (~280K attorneys). WTP: \$149–\$299/mo per seat.

Pains. Pains: Maintains 20–100 client entities in Word + paper binders. Annual meeting season is a 6-week scramble. Fears malpractice from a missed resolution or statute miscite.

Jobs-to-be-done. Jobs: Defensible minutes that cite statute. Track ownership across years. Hand client a clean record book on demand (sale, loan, IRS).

Buying triggers. Triggers: Annual meeting cycle (Jan–Apr); client sale/loan/audit forces records request; office template kit breaks on macOS update.

Where to reach them. Channels: State bar CLEs, ABA Business Law Section, Lawyerist podcast, Clio ecosystem, LinkedIn Sales Nav.

David — Corporate Partner, 10–25 Attorney Firm

Segment: Small-to-mid law firm corporate practice (~8,500 firms in band). WTP: \$999–\$2,499/mo firm-wide.

Pains. Pains: Junior associates re-invent minute formatting. Inconsistent quality exposes firm. Hard to onboard new associates to firm standard.

Jobs-to-be-done. Jobs: Standardize firm's records work product. Train associates faster. Win mid-market clients with AmLaw-quality deliverables.

Buying triggers. Triggers: Associate turnover; losing an RFP on "firm technology"; compliance scare from sister firm.

Where to reach them. Channels: ABA Business Law Section, Legaltech News, ALM events, state bar corporate sections, partner-to-partner referral.

Linda — CPA Practice Owner

Segment: 1–20 staff CPA firms (~32K firms). WTP: \$199–\$499/mo + per-client revenue share.

Pains. Pains: Clients confuse CPA with attorney and ask for minutes. Tax season forces last-minute housekeeping (S-elections, owner draws, loans). No good tool for shareholder loan/capital tracking.

Jobs-to-be-done. Jobs: Add high-margin compliance service without hiring an attorney. Tighten S-Corp reasonable-comp documentation. Differentiate from cheap tax-prep crowd.

Buying triggers. Triggers: Loses client to firm that "handles everything"; IRS notice on undocumented owner loan; year-end planning reveals missing minutes.

Where to reach them. Channels: AICPA ENGAGE, state CPA societies (WICPA, ILCPA, MNCPA), CPA Practice Advisor, Karbon / Canopy ecosystems.

Marcus — Ops Director, Registered-Agent Co.

Segment: ~3,500 registered-agent / CSC firms. WTP: \$2K–\$10K/mo platform + per-entity rev share.

Pains. Pains: Customers ask for ongoing records, they answer "we just do filings." Churn to all-in-one competitors. Building in-house is off-mission.

Jobs-to-be-done. Jobs: Add white-label records to raise ARPU. Reduce churn. Compete with ZenBusiness/Northwest's expanding suites.

Buying triggers. Triggers: Board demands new revenue line; lost RFP on "do you handle minutes?"

Where to reach them. Channels: NAERA, direct BD, industry trade events.

Alex — DIY Founder, 1–3 Entities

Segment: ~6M SMB owners actively self-managing. WTP: \$29–\$79/mo per entity.

Pains. Pains: Got a \$300 LLC kit from LegalZoom 4 years ago, hasn't held a meeting since. Banker asked for annual minutes. Confused which form a single-member LLC needs.

Jobs-to-be-done. Jobs: Look legitimate to bankers/investors/IRS. Spend zero time after setup.

Buying triggers. Triggers: Bank/loan/audit request; selling business; adding a partner.

Where to reach them. Channels: SEO templates, Reddit r/smallbusiness, Indie Hackers, LegalZoom/Incfile partnerships.

7. Pricing & Packaging

Tier	Price	Audience	Entitlements
DIY	\$39/mo · \$399/yr	1 owner, 1–3 entities	Meetings, minutes, ledger, record book; 1 AI draft/entity/yr; email support
Solo Pro ★	\$199/mo per seat	Solo attorneys / CPA practices, ≤100 entities	Unlimited AI drafting; statute-cited templates; PDF binder; annual-review hosted links; standard support
Practice	\$999/mo (5 seats)	10–25 attorney firms / CPA firms	≤500 entities; +\$129/mo per extra seat; RBAC; audit log; bulk migration; priority + CSM
Firm / White-Label	From \$4K/mo (custom)	Registered agents, mid-market firms	Unlimited entities; white-label branding + custom domain; SSO/SAML; API; SLA

★ Solo Pro is the wedge SKU. Optimize the entire funnel toward this tier first.

8. Go-to-Market Strategies

Play A — Wisconsin Attorney Beachhead

Effort: Medium · Impact: High · Payback: 3–4 mo

Own the only statute-cited records product for Wis. Stat. Ch. 180/181/183. Land 50 WI solo/small firms, then port the citation engine state-by-state.

Motions

- Speak/sponsor at State Bar of Wisconsin Business Law Section + CLE events
- Direct outbound to WI corporate attorneys (Sales Nav list, ~3,200 targets)
- Free "Wis. Stat. Compliance Audit" tool — top-of-funnel lead magnet
- Named case study: "How a Madison solo cut annual meeting season from 6 weeks to 9 days"

Success KPIs

- 50 paying WI firms in 6 months
- \$10K MRR from WI by month 6
- NPS > 50

Play B — CPA Channel Partnership

Effort: Medium · Impact: High · Payback: 4–6 mo

Make every CPA a reseller. Bundle entityIQ with year-end S-Corp / owner-comp / loan-documentation workflows. CPA earns 20% recurring rev-share.

Motions

- Build CPA partner portal with co-branded client onboarding
- Pre-built S-Corp reasonable-compensation + shareholder-loan resolution templates
- Sponsor state CPA society fall conferences (WICPA, ILCPA, MNCPA)
- Karbon / Canopy / TaxDome integration listings

Success KPIs

- 100 CPA partner signups in Y1
- 30% of new revenue via partner channel by month 12
- Partner-sourced LTV ≥ 24 mo

Play C — Registered-Agent White-Label

Effort: High · Impact: High · Payback: 9–12 mo

Sell the platform to mid-tier registered-agent companies that want to add records-as-a-service. Avoid competing with CSC/Northwest at the top.

Motions

- White-label theme system (logo, domain, color, PDF letterhead)
- SSO + tenant isolation hardening
- Direct BD to top-200 non-CSC RA firms
- Revenue: \$4K–\$10K platform fee + per-entity rev share

Success KPIs

- 3 signed white-label partners in Y1
- \$30K MRR via white-label by month 18

Play D — SEO + Template-Led Growth

Effort: Low · Impact: Medium · Payback: 6–9 mo

Own long-tail compliance keywords with the best free templates on the internet. Each template gates a "Generate as PDF" CTA.

Motions

- Publish 50 free templates (annual minutes, special meeting, S-Corp election, banking, distribution)
- Target keywords: operating agreement template (4.4K/mo), corporate compliance software (480/mo), entity management software (720/mo, KDI 21), llc record book (70/mo, KDI 12)
- Each template page has a "Generate this as a PDF on entityIQ" CTA (email gate)
- Programmatic SEO: per-state corporate records pages (50 pages)

Success KPIs

- 20K organic sessions/mo by month 12
- 5% template→signup conversion
- \$0.50 CAC for self-serve DIY

Play E — DIY SMB via Incorporator Partnerships

Effort: Medium · Impact: Medium · Payback: 12+ mo

Be the records upsell that ZenBusiness, Incfile, Northwest, and MyCorporation don't want to build.
Rev-share or bounty per converted customer.

Motions

- BD outreach to incorporator product teams
- API to ingest new formation → spin up entityIQ workspace
- Co-branded onboarding email sequence

Success KPIs

- 1 incorporator partnership signed by month 9
- 10K SMB activations in Y2

9. Channel Plan & SEO

Priority SEO keywords (Semrush, US)

Keyword	Vol / mo	KDI	Intent
operating agreement template	4,400	35	DIY template
entity management software	720	21	B2B comparison
corporate compliance software	480	49	B2B
cap table software	390	19	B2B startup
llc record book	70	12	DIY high-intent
annual meeting minutes template	40	19	DIY template
llc minute book	40	11	DIY high-intent
corporate minute book software	20	0	B2B (own this)
stock ledger software	20	0	B2B (own this)
registered agent software	20	0	Partner / B2B

Quick win: own the zero-difficulty "corporate minute book software", "stock ledger software", and "registered agent software" pages immediately. Compete for "entity management software" (KDI 21) within 90 days.

Outbound sequence — Sarah (solo attorney), 5 touches over 12 business days

Day 1 • Email. Subject: "Madison solo cut annual meeting season from 6 weeks to 9 days" — 4-line CTA to a 12-min demo.

Day 3 • LinkedIn. Connection request + soft note. No pitch.

Day 5 • Email. Forward of the WI Compliance Audit tool — free, ungated.

Day 9 • LinkedIn DM. 1-line: "Worth a 12-min look? Here's a 90-sec Loom: [link]."

Day 12 • Breakup email. "Closing the loop — want me to stop reaching out?"

Partnership targets

- State Bar of Wisconsin (Business Law Section) — CLE sponsorship + speaking slots
- WICPA, ILCPA, MNCPA, IACPA, MICPA — fall conference sponsorships
- Clio + MyCase ecosystems — attorney workflow integration
- Karbon, Canopy, TaxDome — CPA practice-management integrations
- AICPA ENGAGE — exhibitor + thought-leadership panel

- Top-200 non-CSC registered-agent firms (NAERA roster) — white-label BD
- Incfile, ZenBusiness, Northwest, MyCorporation — records-upsell BD

10. 90-Day Launch Plan

Wk	Track	Task	Owner
W1	Foundation	Lock pricing page + Solo Pro / Practice checkout	Founder
W1	Foundation	Ship public marketing site with statute-cited positioning	Founder
W2	WI Beachhead	Target list: 3,200 WI corporate attorneys (Sales Nav)	Founder
W2	SEO	Publish first 10 free templates + per-state landing pages	Content
W3	WI Beachhead	Submit CLE speaker proposal — State Bar of WI Business Law Section	Founder
W3	Product	Ship free "Compliance Audit" upload tool (lead magnet)	Eng
W4	Outbound	Launch 5-touch sequence to first 500 WI attorneys	Founder
W5	CPA Channel	Recruit 5 design-partner CPA firms (WICPA roster)	Founder
W6	Product	Ship CPA partner portal MVP + S-Corp templates	Eng
W7	Content	Publish first named case study (WI attorney, on-record)	Content
W8	Outbound	Second outbound wave — next 1,500 WI attorneys	Founder
W9	Partnerships	BD calls with 10 mid-tier RA firms	Founder
W10	Events	Sponsor + speak at WICPA fall conference	Founder
W11	Product	Ship white-label MVP (logo, domain, PDF letterhead)	Eng
W12	Review	QBR: pipeline, MRR, CAC, payback. Double down on best play.	Founder

11. KPI Dashboard

Metric	Definition	Y1 Target
★ North Star	Active Entities Under Management	5,000 by month 12
MRR	Monthly Recurring Revenue	\$50K by month 12
CAC	Blended customer acquisition cost	< \$400 for Solo Pro
Payback	Months to recover CAC	< 4 mo Solo Pro
Logo Retention	12-mo logo retention	> 90%
NPS	Net Promoter Score	> 50
Activation	Trial → first PDF generated	> 60% within 7 days

12. Risks & Mitigations

Risk. Statute citations only cover Wisconsin today

Mitigation. Build a citation-engine abstraction; contract a state-by-state statute mapping rollout (IL, MN, IA, MI in Q2).

Risk. Athenian or a CSC moves down-market

Mitigation. Move fast on pricing + AI features they can't match; lock in CPA channel that enterprise tools won't touch.

Risk. AI hallucinated minutes create malpractice exposure

Mitigation. Lawyer-in-the-loop signing required; AI output watermarked "draft"; insurance partnership in Y2.

Risk. Slow attorney adoption of new tooling

Mitigation. Free migration from Word/Access; bar-association CLE credit for onboarding; case-study-driven sales.

Risk. MinuteBox accelerates US expansion

Mitigation. Out-execute on AI drafting, statute citations, and the CPA channel — MinuteBox has none of these.

13. Appendix — Sources

- IRS Statistics of Income (SOI), Corporation Returns 2023 — irs.gov/statistics
- IRS Exempt Organizations Master File 2024 — irs.gov/charities-non-profits
- ABA Profile of the Legal Profession 2024 — americanbar.org
- AICPA + US Census NAICS 541211 — aicpa.org / census.gov
- NASBA Accountancy Licensee Database 2023 — nasba.org
- Semrush US keyword database (queried June 2026)
- CSC Entity Solutions — cscglobal.com/service/entity-solutions/entity-management
- Diligent Entities — diligent.com/products/entities
- Athennian pricing — athennian.com/pricing
- EntityKeeper pricing — entitykeeper.com/pricing (\$465/mo Corporate, ≤100 entities)
- MinuteBox — minutebox.com
- Harbor Compliance — harborcompliance.com/software
- FileForms — fileforms.com
- Carta — carta.com (cap-table dominance; 2024 trust scandal coverage)
- Pulley — pulley.com/compare/pulley-vs-carta
- Clerky — clerky.com | Stripe Atlas — stripe.com/atlas | Capbase — capbase.com
- Northwest Registered Agent — northwestregisteredagent.com
- ZenBusiness — zenbusiness.com | LegalZoom — legalzoom.com/business | MyCorporation — mycorporation.com